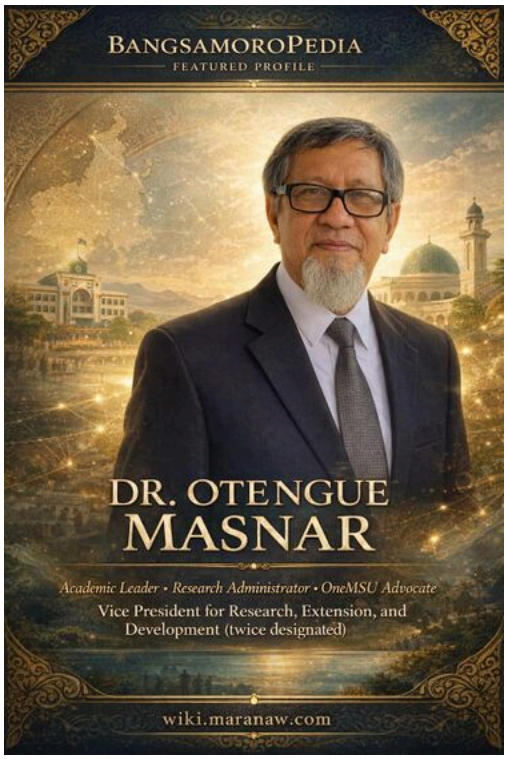
Otengue Masnar

Dr. Otengue Masnar is a distinguished Filipino academic administrator and researcher who shaped the research landscape at Mindanao State University (MSU) in Marawi City. Belonging to the Maranao ethnic group—the "People of the Lake" centered around Lake Lanao—Dr. Masnar stands out for his unique achievement of being designated *twice* as the university's Vice Chancellor (later Vice President) for Research and Extension, a position that put him at the helm of MSU's knowledge production engine. His signature legacy revolves around strengthening the **OneMSU philosophy**, which uses education as the primary tool for peace-building in the conflict-scarred MINSUPALA region (Mindanao, Sulu, and Palawan). Dr. Masnar's work bridges traditional Maranao cultural values with modern scientific administration, ensuring that university research stays globally competitive while remaining deeply rooted in local needs.

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Dr. Otengue Masnar



Born	[Date unknown] Lanao del Sur, Philippines
Nationality	Filipino
Ethnicity	Maranao
Alma mater	Mindanao State University Liceo de Cagayan University
Known for	OneMSU philosophy advocate Twice Vice President for Research and Extension
Title	Vice President for Research, Extension, and Development (twice designated)
Academic background	BS Agriculture Master in Public Administration Doctor of Management

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Early Life and Background

Dr. Masnar hails from a family with deep institutional ties to Mindanao State University. The Masnar lineage represents a multi-generational commitment to academic service, with relatives like Sohra B. Masnar and Mohammad Ayyub C. Masnar continuing the tradition in administrative and research roles at MSU's Main Campus in Marawi City. Growing up within the Maranao community, which has historically faced marginalization and conflict in the southern Philippines, Dr. Masnar developed an early understanding of the critical role education plays in social transformation and peace-building.

The Maranao people, known for their rich Islamic heritage and intricate cultural traditions around Lake Lanao, have long contributed scholars and leaders to the region's academic institutions. Dr. Masnar's background in this community deeply influenced his later emphasis on indigenous knowledge systems and cultural integration in university research programs.

Education

Dr. Masnar's academic journey reflects a deliberate progression from technical agricultural expertise to high-level administrative leadership. His educational credentials include:

- **Bachelor of Science in Agriculture** — Mindanao State University, Marawi City. This foundational degree grounded him in the practical challenges of agricultural development in Mindanao, particularly issues affecting rural and indigenous communities.
- **Master in Public Administration** (1995) — Mindanao State University, Marawi City. This degree marked his transition from technical work to institutional leadership, equipping him with the skills needed for university governance.
- **Doctoral Studies in Philippine Studies** — Mindanao State University, Marawi City. These studies deepened his understanding of the socio-political dynamics of the Philippines, particularly the historical context of Muslim Mindanao.
- **Doctor of Management, major in Leadership and Organization** — Liceo de Cagayan University. This terminal degree formalized his expertise in organizational behavior and strategic leadership, preparing him for executive-level academic administration.

This educational path—combining agriculture, public administration, cultural studies, and management—uniquely positioned Dr. Masnar to understand the multifaceted challenges facing Mindanao State University as both an academic institution and a social catalyst.

Career

Dr. Masnar's professional trajectory is inseparable from the institutional development of Mindanao State University. His career followed a steady ascent through the university's research infrastructure, culminating in his unprecedented double designation as Vice Chancellor (later renamed Vice President) for Research and Extension.

Early Academic Positions

After completing his agricultural studies, Dr. Masnar initially worked in roles that combined teaching with agricultural extension work. These early positions exposed him to the realities of knowledge transfer between university researchers and rural communities, particularly indigenous groups and farming families around Lake Lanao.

Vice Chancellor/Vice President for Research and Extension

Dr. Masnar's most significant contribution came through his leadership of the Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research, Extension, and Development (OVCRED). Being designated to this position *twice* represents an extraordinary vote of confidence in his administrative capabilities—a rare achievement in Philippine higher education. In this role, he succeeded notable Maranao scholars such as Dr. Mamitua Saber, inheriting and expanding upon a legacy of using research as a tool for regional development.

His responsibilities encompassed:

Knowledge Production: Dr. Masnar oversaw research initiatives that directly addressed the socio-cultural and economic challenges facing the Bangsamoro region. He prioritized studies that documented indigenous knowledge systems, assessed institutional effectiveness, and explored pathways to peace in conflict-affected areas.

Community Extension: He transformed how MSU's research reached surrounding communities. Rather than treating research as a purely academic exercise, he ensured that innovations and technologies developed at the university were actively disseminated to indigenous peoples, farming communities, and local government units.

Sustainable Development: Dr. Masnar championed research and extension programs focused on environmental conservation, particularly the protection of the Lake Lanao watershed—a critical ecological and cultural resource for the Maranao people.

Consultant and Advisor

Beyond his university roles, Dr. Masnar served as a consultant and resource person for regional government projects in Marawi City and the Lanao provinces. His expertise was particularly sought after for initiatives involving public policy, indigenous integration, and peace-building strategies.

Institutional Contributions

Dr. Masnar's impact on MSU extends far beyond administrative efficiency. He fundamentally reshaped how the university approached research, community engagement, and its role in regional peace-building.

OneMSU Philosophy

Dr. Masnar is credited with strengthening and operationalizing the **OneMSU philosophy**, which positions education—particularly research and extension work—as the primary mechanism for achieving lasting peace in Mindanao. This philosophy emerged from the recognition that MSU, as a state university serving a predominantly Muslim region, has a unique responsibility to bridge cultural divides and counter narratives of conflict.

Under Dr. Masnar's leadership, the OneMSU philosophy translated into concrete programs:

- Integration of peace-building concepts into research methodologies and extension curricula
- Support for studies examining student and community perceptions of the Mindanao conflict
- Development of conflict resolution training programs for students and community members
- Promotion of interfaith dialogue and cultural exchange within the university

Professionalization of Research Culture

Dr. Masnar is widely recognized for professionalizing MSU's research environment. When he assumed leadership, the university's research output was fragmented and lacked systematic coordination. He introduced:

- Standardized research protocols and ethics review processes
- Mentorship programs for early-career researchers and faculty members
- Incentive structures that rewarded publication in peer-reviewed journals
- Partnerships with national and international research institutions

These reforms elevated MSU's research profile and increased its competitiveness for research grants and academic recognition.

Cultural-Scientific Integration

One of Dr. Masnar's signature contributions was his insistence that modern scientific methods could—and should—coexist with respect for traditional knowledge systems. He supported interdisciplinary research projects documenting **ethnoscience among indigenous groups in Mindanao**, which preserved traditional ecological knowledge while subjecting it to rigorous academic inquiry. This approach resonated deeply with Maranao cultural values while advancing the university's scientific mission.

Research and Publications

Dr. Masnar's scholarly work focuses on the intersection of organizational management, institutional trust, and the social dynamics of higher education in conflict-affected regions.

Organizational Health Studies

One of his most cited works examines **Organizational Health at Mindanao State University**, a quantitative and qualitative study assessing how administrative structures impact faculty effectiveness and the overall academic environment. This research provided empirical evidence for administrative reforms and highlighted the challenges of maintaining institutional integrity in a post-conflict setting.

Institutional Trust Research

Dr. Masnar conducted groundbreaking research on the **factors affecting institutional trust among students** at MSU. This study examined how social trust, perceived corruption, and institutional performance influence students' confidence in their university—a critical factor in retention and academic success. His findings have implications for university governance across the Philippines, particularly in regions with histories of political instability.

Peace Education Scholarship

Through his administrative role, Dr. Masnar supported and contributed to research on **student perceptions of the Mindanao conflict**. These studies aimed to understand how young people in the region process narratives of conflict and how education can foster national unity and solidarity. This research directly informed curriculum development and extension programming.

Publications and Dissemination

Dr. Masnar's work has been published in regional and international journals, and he has presented at academic conferences focused on higher education in Southeast Asia. His research is frequently cited in studies on institutional governance, peace education, and indigenous knowledge systems.

Recognition and Awards

Dr. Masnar's career is distinguished by numerous institutional honors that reflect his impact on MSU and the broader academic community.

Institutional Leadership Honors

- **Dual Vice Chancellor Designation**: The rare distinction of being designated twice as Vice Chancellor/Vice President for Research and Extension represents the highest level of institutional confidence in his leadership abilities.
- **Loyalty and Service Awards**: Dr. Masnar has been honored multiple times during MSU's annual Loyalty Awards ceremonies, which recognize personnel who have dedicated decades to the university's growth and stability.
- **Senior Academic Leadership**: His status as a veteran administrator earned him positions on elite university bodies, including advisory roles with the MSU Board of Regents and participation in system-wide strategic planning committees.

Professional Distinctions

- **Expert in Public Administration**: Regional government agencies have recognized Dr. Masnar as a leading expert on public policy and indigenous integration, frequently calling on him as a consultant.
- **Research Mentorship Excellence**: He has been commended for his role in developing the next generation of scholars at MSU, with many of his mentees now leading research initiatives across the university system.
- **Peace and Cultural Advocacy Awards**: Local and regional peace-building organizations have recognized Dr. Masnar's efforts in promoting intercultural understanding and dialogue within academic settings.

Challenges and Controversies

While Dr. Masnar's career has been marked by notable achievements, his tenure also coincided with significant challenges facing MSU and the broader Marawi community.

Institutional Resource Constraints

Like many state universities in the Philippines, MSU has long struggled with inadequate funding and infrastructure. Dr. Masnar frequently faced the challenge of maintaining research quality and supporting faculty development with limited resources. His ability to secure external grants and partnerships became crucial to sustaining OVCRED's operations.

Navigating Political Dynamics

MSU operates within a complex political environment, where regional, ethnic, and religious affiliations can influence university governance. Dr. Masnar had to navigate these dynamics carefully, balancing the interests of different stakeholder groups while maintaining academic integrity and institutional neutrality.

Post-Marawi Siege Impact

The 2017 Siege of Marawi—a five-month armed conflict that devastated the city—profoundly impacted MSU. The university was forced to relocate temporarily, and many facilities were damaged or destroyed. While the timeline of Dr. Masnar's tenure in relation to this event is not definitively documented, the institutional trauma affected all MSU administrators and faculty. Rebuilding research capacity in the aftermath required extraordinary resilience and strategic planning.

Legacy

Dr. Otengue Masnar's legacy at MSU is multifaceted, extending beyond his administrative accomplishments to encompass a vision of education as a transformative force in conflict-affected regions.

Institutionalization of Peace Education

Dr. Masnar's most enduring contribution may be his role in making peace education a core institutional value at MSU. By integrating peace-building concepts into research and extension work, he ensured that future generations of students and faculty would approach their academic work through a lens of social responsibility and conflict resolution.

Model for Cultural-Scientific Integration

His success in harmonizing traditional Maranao values with modern scientific standards provides a replicable model for other universities serving indigenous and minority communities. Dr. Masnar demonstrated that respecting cultural heritage and pursuing academic excellence are not mutually exclusive—they can reinforce each other when approached thoughtfully.

Development of Research Infrastructure

The professionalization of MSU's research culture under Dr. Masnar's leadership created lasting institutional capacity. The systems, mentorship networks, and quality standards he established continue to shape research practices at the university.

Inspiration for Future Leaders

As a Maranao scholar who rose to the highest levels of academic administration, Dr. Masnar serves as an inspiration for students from marginalized communities. His career trajectory demonstrates that excellence, integrity, and cultural pride can coexist and propel individuals to positions of institutional leadership.

Personal Values and Philosophy

Throughout his career, Dr. Masnar emphasized several core values that shaped his leadership style and institutional priorities:

Academic Integrity: He maintained strict standards for research ethics and transparency, even when political or financial pressures might have suggested shortcuts.

Evidence-Based Practice: Dr. Masnar insisted that administrative decisions be grounded in data and research, modeling the scientific approach he expected from faculty.

Social Impact: He consistently evaluated research and extension programs based on their potential to improve lives in surrounding communities, particularly among vulnerable populations.

Inclusiveness: Dr. Masnar advocated for research that gave voice to marginalized groups, including indigenous peoples, women, and conflict-affected populations.

Preservation of Indigenous Identity: While embracing modern academic standards, he remained committed to documenting and preserving the cultural knowledge systems of Mindanao's diverse ethnic groups.

See Also

- Mindanao State University
- Maranao people
- Marawi
- Bangsamoro
- Lake Lanao
- Peace education
- Indigenous knowledge

External Links

- Mindanao State University Official Website (https://www.msumain.edu.ph/)
- Office of the Vice Chancellor for Research, Extension, and Development (https://ovcred.msumain.edu.ph/about/)
- Research on Organizational Health at MSU (https://www.researchgate.net/publication/304486678_Organizational_Health_at_the_Mindanao_State_University_Marawi_City_Philippines)

- Research on Institutional Trust at MSU (https://www.researchgate.net/publication/380017617_Factors_of_Institutional_Trust_A_Study_of_Students_in_Mindanao_State_University-Marawi_City)

Profile suggested by Sittie HaNimah M. Masnar (https://www.facebook.com/Sittie.Nimah)

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